

In the Line of Sight



For the severely myopic, here's a tiny piece of acrylic that, when implanted inside the eye, gives 20/40 vision (you can legally drive without glasses, that is). It reduces refractive error and is called 'phakic' because the eye retains its natural lens. The micro-lens is placed behind the cornea through a tiny incision and in front of the eye's natural lens. The implant works by bending light rays so that they focus on the retina.

Off the Dribble



At least five million men across the world face this embarrassing tendency. And most rarely seek help. Triggered off by a varied reasons—prostate abnormalities, head and spinal cord injury, neurological and degenerative diseases, infections, the ageing process, excessive alcohol or medication, and of course emotional trauma—urinary incontinence, or loss of bladder control, is a treatable condition. Dr Rakesh Kapoor, professor and head of urology at SGPGI, Lucknow, has come up with a new technique to give such patients a new lease of life. Kapoor's contraption can be concealed inside one's innerwear. No social awkwardness, no catheter discomfort. You can just wash, use and be on the go. *by Subhash Mishra*

11%

IS THE FALL IN THE NUMBER OF OBESE PEOPLE IN THE PAST YEAR, ACCORDING TO THE APOLLO WELLNESS GROUP.

Walking Naturally

Did you know that your feet are designed for soft natural surfaces like sand and soil? Unfortunately, we spend most of our time walking on unnatural and hard surfaces that force our feet to pronate (roll over) excessively to gain ground contact. Around 70 per cent people worldwide get aches and pain in their legs and feet due to this. Orthaheel footcare range, new in India, is scientifically designed to re-align and support your feet. Lightweight, they offer great walking comfort.



Last Gasp

India is now advocating the adoption of HFA asthma inhalers, which are free from ozone-depleting chlorofluorocarbons. The medicine in the

new inhalers may feel, sound, smell and taste a bit different. But as experts point out, it provides the same health benefits without damaging the ozone layer.



A BRAINY BYPASS



A heart bypass surgery is common enough but when the problem lies in the brain, a rare procedure is called for—a brain bypass operation. Stroke patient, Ahmed, 14, from Iraq has just gone through one at Apollo Indraprastha in Delhi. Not more than a handful of doctors around the world have done the surgery, making Ahmed a rare lucky survivor.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**